Jago Dither

Pictures into patterns.

Bring a favourite picture to the print table. Find a few good inks, make the texture crunchy or gentle, and see what happens when the marks start moving. Jago Dither is a print workshop for images, lettering and little animated scenes.

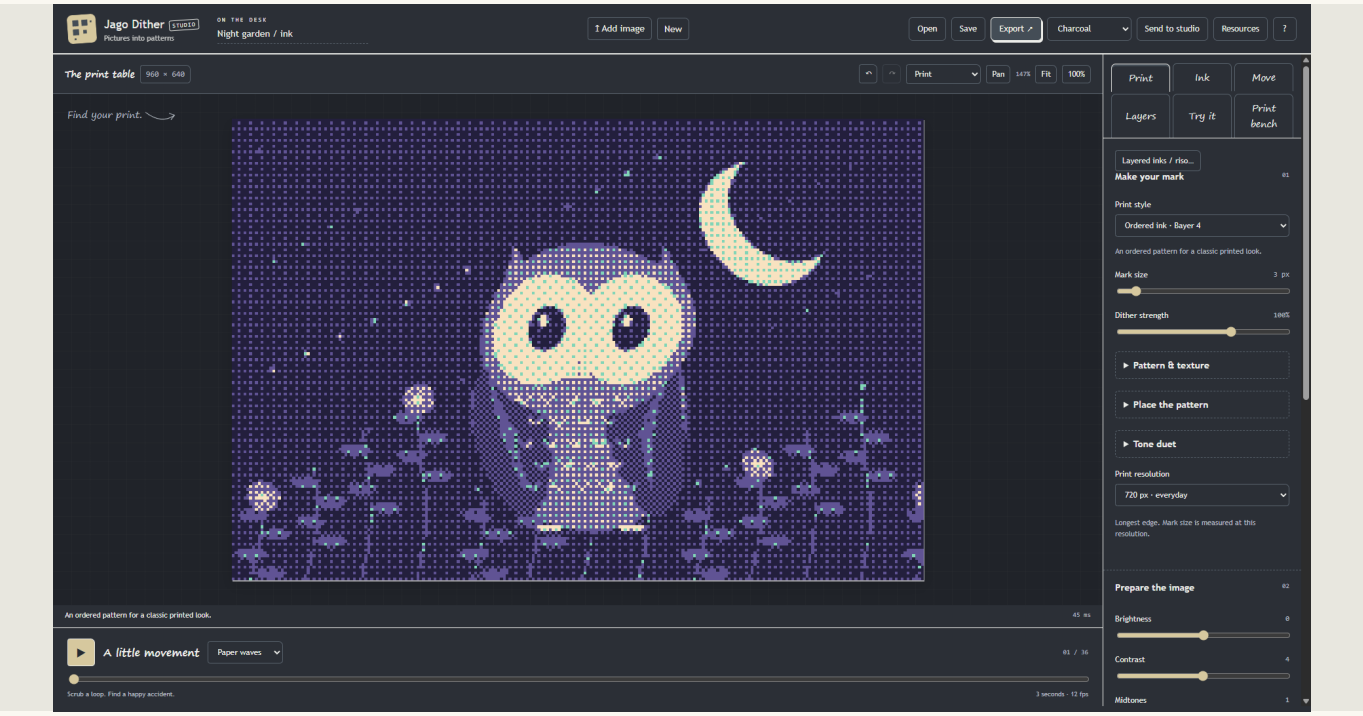


A good place to begin

Turn artwork into printed textures, limited-colour images and animated dithering. Free, local and editable.

Inside this guide
Start with a small project. Explore the toolbox. Choose the right export. Take the result into another studio.

Start small. Make it yours.



1. Bring in artwork

Use Add image or start with text, gradients and other source layers.

2. Find the print

Choose a method in Print, then adjust mark size, strength and resolution. Compare several treatments of the same image.

3. Choose your colours

Open Ink to choose a palette. Print bench gives you layered inks; use the individual toggles or bypass the ink stack when needed.

4. Make a useful export

Save the project and export a PNG or a loop. Use plate or palette exports when the next step needs them.

Your toolbox

Find your print

Explore error diffusion, ordered Bayer patterns, threshold, character art and patterned marks.

Try grain, dots, lines, crosshatching, rings, diamonds, weave and custom threshold tiles.

Adjust brightness, contrast, gamma, saturation, edges, diffusion and mark placement.

Tone duet combines two textures across the tones of one image.

Gradient maps recolour the artwork before printing; palette extraction helps find colours already in your picture.

Optional selective colour treatment works in two directions: treat selected colours, or protect them and treat everything else. Tolerance and source/palette choices refine the result.

Mix your inks

Build a limited palette with editable colours, or start from an ink set.

Print bench layers translucent inks over paper, with individual density, screen, spacing and registration settings.

Switch an ink on or off directly, or bypass the layered ink treatment altogether.

Square, diamond and ring screens join the other layered-print screen options.

Compare print directions previews several treatments of your own artwork before you choose one.

Palette files and recipes let you reuse a direction without replacing the source artwork.

A print that moves

Combine whole-print motion with animated texture.

Layer images, editable lettering, gradients, imported frame sequences and atmospheric overlays.

Stars, sparkles, lights and dust can twinkle, pulse or drift, either before the print treatment or above it.

Distress and effects include colour separation, scanlines, tape slip and block shuffle.

Compare original and printed artwork with a draggable divider, a side-by-side export or an animated reveal.

A useful print kit

Export individual black alpha coverage plates, a colour proof and reusable settings.

Add trap/spread and registration marks, choose whether paper uses the lightest ink, and inspect an offset registration proof.

Import and export GPL, JSON and plain hex palettes.

Bring a Wobble loop into Dither, or return rendered ink artwork to Wobble for further drawing.

Take it further.

Save the editable source

Your native project keeps the studio-specific editing information. Save it before making finished exports or passing a rendered result to another tool.

Export options

Editable .jagodither projects
Reusable .ditherrecipe settings
PNG stills and comparison artwork
Animated GIF
PNG frame sequences
Ink coverage plates, proofs and recipes
GPL, JSON and hex palettes
Character-grid text
Wobble project transfers

Wobble

Continue with a printed still or timed frame sequence.

Repeat

Build a pattern from a printed motif or texture.

Library

Prepare poster layouts and organise PNGs, palettes or plate proofs.

Useful things to know.

Print plates are creative RGB separations, not calibrated CMYK proofing. Confirm requirements with your printer.

GIF has hard transparency; PNG retains soft transparency.

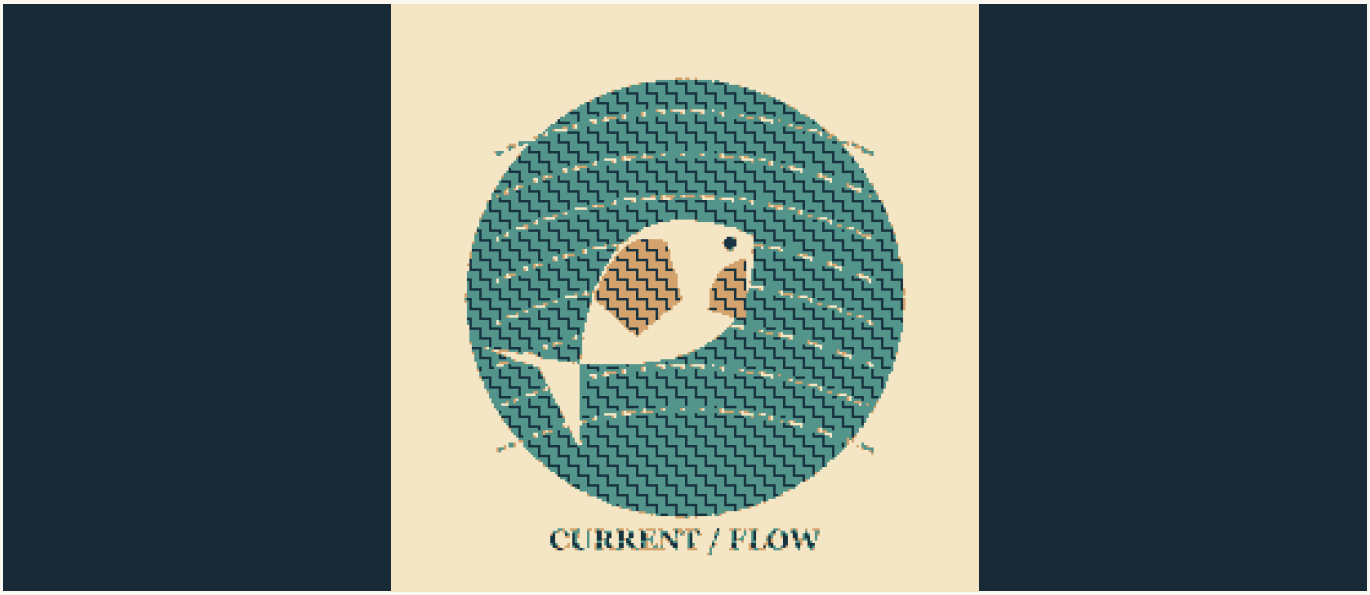
Do not promise general animated GIF or video import from the older page. Supported still-image and Jago frame-sequence workflows are the safe claims.

Rendered transfers are not a lossless round trip of every editable source layer.

Open it again

Download the ZIP and choose Extract All. Open Jago-Dither.exe from the extracted folder. For offline browser use, open Jago-Dither.html. Workscape is a Windows companion. Keep native support folders with their Windows app.

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Another direction to explore with Jago Dither.